

C205

Leading Teams

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A six-person product team was formed in January with members from three offices. By week four, meetings are tense: two members argue over who owns the roadmap and others question the leader's priorities. The team shares a well-funded budget and a new collaboration tool. Which stage is the team in?

- A. The team has failed and should be disbanded.
- B. Forming.
- C. Storming.
- D. Norming.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A team has agreed on meeting rules, settled who owns each task, and members now give each other feedback openly, but output has not yet peaked. Which stage is it in?

- A. Performing.
- B. Storming.
- C. Norming.
- D. Adjourning.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

The company's strategy this year is to reduce customer churn. A customer-support team lead, who was top performer two years running, proposes several team goals at the offsite. Which goal is best?

- A. Raise first-contact resolution from 68% to 80% by December 31 to cut churn-driving repeat calls.
- B. Answer 100% of calls in under 5 seconds by next week.
- C. Deliver world-class support that customers love.
- D. Cut the team's paper use by 30% by June.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A team goal reads: “Improve onboarding for new clients.” Which change would turn it into a SMART goal?

- A.** Add a deadline only.
- B.** Assign it to the whole company.
- C.** Make it more inspiring, such as “Wow every new client.”
- D.** Add a measure and deadline, such as cutting onboarding time from 30 to 20 days by Q3.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

After a new manager started holding blameless reviews of mistakes, the number of errors her nursing-informatics team reported rose from 4 to 11 per month. The team also moved to a larger office on the fifth floor. A director wants to reverse the policy. What is the most likely explanation for the rise?

- A.** The office move disrupted the team's work.
- B.** Greater psychological safety means errors that were hidden are now being reported.
- C.** The team got worse under the new manager.
- D.** Blameless reviews always cause carelessness.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A team lead with an MBA and ten years of industry experience promised her team that any overtime would be offset with paid time off. Over the last quarter, she approved overtime twice but denied the time off both times, citing deadlines. She is known as a strong presenter. What is happening to her credibility?

- A.** It is eroding, because her actions do not match her stated commitments.
- B.** It is intact because of her degree and experience.
- C.** It is unaffected; trust depends only on communication skill.
- D.** It is growing because she meets deadlines.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A recent graduate joins a data team and is eager to build her first dashboard, though she has never used the company's reporting tool. She sits near the window and asked for a second monitor on day one. Which leadership style fits her on this task?

- A. Coaching every employee the same way regardless of task.
- B. Delegating: give her the goal and step back.
- C. Supporting: mainly encouragement with little direction.
- D. Directing: clear instructions and close supervision.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A leader gives a team member a project goal and deadline and then steps back, checking in only at milestones. For which member is this style the best fit?

- A. Any member, since stepping back always builds ownership.
- B. A new hire who is excited but has never done this kind of project.
- C. An experienced member who has done similar projects well and is motivated to lead this one.
- D. A skilled member who has recently lost confidence after a setback.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A marketing team of eight produced a weak campaign plan. Each member added to a shared slide deck, and the team was graded only as a group. The team's budget was cut 5% last year. Several members admit they left the work to others. What change best reduces this problem next time?

- A. Restore the budget cut.
- B. Assign named owners for each section and review individual contributions.
- C. Add three more members to share the load.
- D. Offer a bigger bonus for the team as a whole.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A leader notices that on a large task force, effort seems to drop as more people join. What does social loafing predict about per-person effort as group size grows when contributions are pooled?

- A.** It tends to rise from friendly competition.
- B.** It stays the same regardless of size.
- C.** It depends only on members' pay levels.
- D.** It tends to fall.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A tight-knit leadership team that has worked together for eight years must pick a vendor by Friday. The CEO opens the meeting by saying which vendor she prefers, and everyone agrees within ten minutes. The meeting was catered by a local deli. What should the CEO do differently next time?

- A.** Nothing; fast agreement shows a strong, cohesive team.
- B.** Hold her view until others speak and assign someone to argue against the favored option.
- C.** Extend the deadline and change nothing else.
- D.** Replace the whole team with new members.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A project coordinator, who often stays late and has a dry sense of humor, turned in a status report with three wrong dates. Her supervisor wants to help her improve. Which feedback is most effective?

- A.** "Three dates in Tuesday's report were wrong, and the client planned around them. Let's add a check against the schedule before you send."
- B.** "You're careless with details."
- C.** "Your late nights must be making you tired."
- D.** "Great job overall — keep it up!"

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

A six-person product team was formed in January ~~with members from three offices~~. By week four, meetings are tense: two members argue over who owns the roadmap and others question the leader's priorities. ~~The team shares a well-funded budget and a new collaboration tool~~. Which stage is the team in?

Target word: name the stage **Decides:** Open conflict over roles and direction.

A	Absolute language	Storming is a normal stage; conflict can be worked through.
B	Confusion set	Forming is polite and tentative, not openly conflicted.
C	Correct	Disputes over ownership and challenges to the leader mark storming.
D	Confusion set	Norming comes after roles and rules are agreed.

2. Answer C Concept 1 • transfer

A team has agreed on meeting rules, settled who owns each task, and members now give each other feedback openly, but output has not yet peaked. Which stage is it in?

Target word: stage from settled norms **Decides:** Shared rules and roles are set, but not yet high performance.

A	Dropped element	Ignores the fact that output has not peaked.
B	Inverted operation	Storming is the conflict before norms are set, the opposite of this picture.
C	Correct	Agreed norms and roles with rising cohesion define norming.
D	Confusion set	Adjourning is the team wrapping up its work.

3. Answer A Concept 2

The company's strategy this year is to reduce customer churn. A customer-support team lead, ~~who was top performer two years running~~, proposes several team goals ~~at the offsite~~. Which goal is best?

Target word: best SMART, aligned goal **Decides:** The goal must be measurable, time-bound, and tied to churn.

A	Correct	Specific, measurable, achievable, time-bound, and linked to the churn strategy.
B	Absolute language	Measurable but not achievable in that time frame.
C	Dropped element	Drops measure and deadline; inspiring but not testable.
D	Adjacent category	SMART in form but not relevant to the churn goal.

4. Answer D Concept 2 • transfer

A team goal reads: "Improve onboarding for new clients." Which change would turn it into a SMART goal?

Target word: what is missing **Decides:** The goal lacks a measure and a deadline.

A	Dropped element	Still lacks a measure of what counts as improved.
B	Adjacent category	Changes ownership, not the goal's structure.
C	Inverted operation	Moves further from measurable, not closer.
D	Correct	Adds the measurable and time-bound elements the goal lacks.

5. Answer B Concept 3

After a new manager started holding blameless reviews of mistakes, the number of errors her nursing-informatics team reported rose from 4 to 11 per month. ~~The team also moved to a larger office on the fifth floor.~~ A director wants to reverse the policy. What is the most likely explanation for the rise?

Target word: meaning of more reported errors **Decides:** Blameless reviews make people safe to report mistakes.

A	Camouflage	The move is incidental; the policy change explains the reporting.
B	Correct	Safe teams surface more mistakes, which lets them learn and fix them.
C	Inverted operation	Reads a reporting increase as a performance decline.
D	Absolute language	No such rule; accountability can remain while blame is removed.

6. Answer A Concept 4

A team lead ~~with an MBA and ten years of industry experience~~ promised her team that any overtime would be offset with paid time off. Over the last quarter, she approved overtime twice but denied the time off both times, citing deadlines. ~~She is known as a strong presenter.~~ What is happening to her credibility?

Target word: effect on trust **Decides:** Her actions do not match her promise.

A	Correct	Behavioral integrity — keeping promises — is the base of credibility.
B	Camouflage	Credentials do not offset broken promises.
C	Absolute language	Presenting well cannot replace consistency of word and deed.
D	Adjacent category	Results matter, but they do not repair a trust breach.

7. Answer D Concept 5

A recent graduate joins a data team and is eager to build her first dashboard, though she has never used the company's reporting tool. ~~She sits near the window and asked for a second monitor on day one.~~ Which leadership style fits her on this task?

Target word: style for readiness level **Decides:** Low skill, high enthusiasm for this task.

A	Absolute language	Situational leadership varies the style by person and task.
B	Inverted operation	Delegating fits high skill and commitment, the opposite of her readiness.
C	Adjacent category	Supporting fits skilled people with shaky confidence; she lacks skill, not confidence.
D	Correct	An enthusiastic beginner needs structure and direction.

8. Answer C Concept 5 • transfer

A leader gives a team member a project goal and deadline and then steps back, checking in only at milestones. For which member is this style the best fit?

Target word: readiness for delegating **Decides:** Delegating fits high competence and high commitment.

A	Absolute language	Stepping back from an unready member sets them up to fail.
B	Inverted operation	That profile needs directing, the opposite style.
C	Correct	High skill and high commitment call for delegating.
D	Adjacent category	That profile calls for supporting, not full delegation.

9. Answer B Concept 6

A marketing team of eight produced a weak campaign plan. Each member added to a shared slide deck, and the team was graded only as a group. ~~The team's budget was cut 5% last year.~~ Several members admit they left the work to others. What change best reduces this problem next time?

Target word: fix for loafing **Decides:** Individual contributions were not identifiable.

A	Camouflage	Funding was not what caused the lack of effort.
B	Correct	Visible, accountable individual work reduces social loafing.
C	Inverted operation	Larger groups make loafing worse, not better.
D	Dropped element	Keeps rewards group-level and still hides who did what.

10. Answer D Concept 6 · transfer

A leader notices that on a large task force, effort seems to drop as more people join. What does social loafing predict about per-person effort as group size grows when contributions are pooled?

Target word: direction of effect **Decides:** Pooled, unidentifiable effort falls per person as size rises.

A	Inverted operation	Reverses the effect; rising effort needs visible individual results.
B	Absolute language	Effort is sensitive to identifiability and size.
C	Adjacent category	Pay affects motivation but is not the loafing mechanism.
D	Correct	More people and pooled output make each contribution less visible.

11. Answer B Concept 7

A tight-knit leadership team that has worked together for eight years must pick a vendor by Friday. The CEO opens the meeting by saying which vendor she prefers, and everyone agrees within ten minutes. ~~The meeting was catered by a local deli.~~ What should the CEO do differently next time?

Target word: how to prevent groupthink **Decides:** Leader spoke first; no dissent in a cohesive group under time pressure.

A	Inverted operation	Quick unanimity under pressure is a warning sign, not a strength.
B	Correct	Withholding the leader's opinion and a devil's advocate counter groupthink.
C	Dropped element	Removes one pressure but leaves the leader's early signal in place.
D	Absolute language	Extreme; process changes address groupthink without breaking up the team.

12. Answer A Concept 8

A project coordinator, ~~who often stays late and has a dry sense of humor,~~ turned in a status report with three wrong dates. Her supervisor wants to help her improve. Which feedback is most effective?

Target word: best developmental feedback **Decides:** Specific behavior, impact, and a path forward.

A	Correct	Specific, behavioral, timely, shows impact, and offers a fix.
B	Adjacent category	Labels a trait instead of naming a behavior.
C	Camouflage	Reacts to the late hours, which do not explain or fix the errors.
D	Dropped element	Drops the specific issue entirely.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	6	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	8	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	8	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	3	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	4	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Stages of team development	Teams move through forming (polite, unclear), storming (conflict over roles and direction), norming (agreed ways of working), performing (high output), and adjourning (closure).	Reading open conflict as a sign the team has failed rather than as storming.	Behaviors described: politeness, pushback, shared rules, or self-managed results.
2	Aligned SMART goals	Team goals should be specific, measurable, achievable, relevant to organizational goals, and time-bound, so the team's work visibly supports the larger strategy.	Accepting an inspiring but unmeasurable goal, or a measurable goal that does not connect to the organization's priorities.	A goal statement missing a number, a deadline, or a link to strategy.
3	Psychological safety	Members of psychologically safe teams feel able to admit mistakes, ask questions, and challenge ideas without fear of punishment, which increases learning and error reporting.	Treating more reported errors as proof of a worse team.	People hiding mistakes or staying silent in meetings.
4	Credibility through behavioral integrity	Leaders build credibility and trust by doing what they say, consistently, over time; words that are not matched by actions erode trust.	Thinking title, expertise, or charisma alone creates trust.	A gap between what a leader promised and what the leader did.
5	Situational leadership	Match the style to the follower's readiness: low skill/high enthusiasm needs directing; some skill/low confidence needs coaching; high skill/variable confidence needs supporting; high skill/high commitment suits delegating.	Using one style for everyone, or delegating to an eager beginner.	A description of the member's skill and confidence for this specific task.
6	Social loafing	People exert less effort in groups when individual contributions are not identifiable; making each person's contribution visible and accountable reduces it.	Fixing loafing by adding more people or more group-level rewards.	A team result where no one can say who did what.
7	Groupthink	Cohesive teams under pressure can suppress dissent to keep harmony; leaders counter it by inviting critique, assigning a devil's advocate, and withholding their own view early.	Seeing quick unanimous agreement as a sign of a strong team.	No one raised concerns, and the leader spoke first.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
8	Effective developmental feedback	Feedback that develops people is specific, about observable behavior and its impact, timely, and paired with a path forward.	Giving general praise or personality labels and calling it feedback.	Feedback that names a trait (“you’re careless”) rather than a behavior.

Course scope (public description): This course helps students establish team objectives, align the team purpose with organizational goals, build credibility and trust, and develop the talents of individuals to enhance team performance.